13.5.4 Consistency through shared components

All PEPs—gateway, service, and UI—use the same decision interface and schema definitions. Each constructs a PARC-structured request using a common SDK and forwards it to the appropriate PDP. This consistency guarantees that:

- **Decisions are consistent**. The same request always yields the same result, no matter where it's enforced.
- **Policies are centralized**. Changes to policy logic don't need modifications to PEP code.
- **Auditing is centralized**. Each decision is logged in a shared system, marked with the enforcement layer that caused it.

This shared architecture gives C³ what the original Customer Collaboration platform lacked: a single, consistent process for every authorization decision. Whether a request comes from the API gateway, a microservice, or the UI, it is assessed using the same schema, policies, and data sources. Consistency isn't just a design feature; it's what enables C³ to confidently scale authorization across hundreds of tenants without sacrificing clarity or control.

13.5.5 Operational trade-offs

Different enforcement points have varying strengths and weaknesses based on their position in the stack. Table 13.2 summarizes how gateway, service, and UI enforcement balance context, control, and complexity.